slipped the key into her pocket and told her to run.

Maman had taught her to hold essential things close to her heart so that no one could steal them from her, which is why she made secret wishes to herself—that her mother wouldn't die, that she and Léa would always be together, that she would be reunited with André. She called them her little markers, holding them close. Of course, they didn't always come true, but they were something she could hope for. She wouldn't even tell Léa about them because her sister was too rational and solid, like the keys on the typewriter, to understand something like wishes.

"I don't want Léa to go alone. We've always been together. If she goes, I'm going with her."

"There's no guarantee you'd stay together."

"You said you could negotiate with the German Employment Office on Léa's behalf. Can't you tell them that in addition to Léa, her sister will volunteer to work in Germany?"

His gaze flicked toward the window.

"Two workers must be more valuable than one," she said. "Isn't that leverage?"

"I could make the argument," he said quietly.

"All I ask is that if Léa agrees to go, then keep us together, send us to the same place."

"I'll try." He gave her a tight smile.

"There's one other thing I must ask of you."

"Yes?"

"Once you've come to an agreement with the German Employment Office and know where we're going, I'd like you to write to someone on my behalf."

"Of course."

"He's from Orléans and was sent to Germany a few months ago." Rose handed Maître Mallon a small card with a name written on it. "Unfortunately, I don't have his address in Germany. Would it be possible for you to discover where he's been sent and write to inform him of where I am in Germany?" It was an impossible dream, but Rose had to try. "In case we aren't far from one another, or if there is any chance we could meet."

"André Simon," he read the name aloud. "The German Employment Office will have his file." He thought for a moment. "I can tell them he was